

LivedIn

Verified Rental Review Platform

Product Requirements Document

Updated Edition — April 2026

Team: Team Renter
Course: Tech LiftOff
Version: 2.0
Status: Expanded scope (Business Portal + Consumer UX)

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Product Overview

Description

LivedIn is a **two-sided verified review platform** for rental properties that reduces risk for tenants pre-lease signing and gives landlords actionable insight into their portfolio reputation.

For renters, the platform scores rental properties on an objective scale using five structured metrics. By enforcing structure and verification, the platform minimises fake or retaliatory reviews and gives tenants reliable, comparable signals when evaluating rental properties before signing a lease.

For landlords and property managers, the platform provides a Business Portal with portfolio analytics, benchmark comparisons, review response capabilities, renter sentiment tracking, and team access management. Landlords can monitor and improve their reputation through data-driven insights rather than guesswork.

Two-Sided Marketplace Model

LivedIn operates as a two-sided trust marketplace:

- **Renters** browse properties, read trust scores and category breakdowns, compare options, and submit verified reviews.
- **Landlords/Property Managers** monitor portfolio performance, track renter sentiment, respond to reviews (subject to admin approval), identify review gaps, and manage team access.

Both sides benefit from the same underlying data: verified, structured reviews aggregated into trust scores. Renters produce the data; landlords consume and act on it.

User Problem

Existing tenant screening practices focus on financial and legal eligibility, but tenants currently have no reliable way to evaluate the *lived experience* of a rental property before committing to a lease.

- Renters—especially first-time renters—rely on subjective “vibes” during showings and word-of-mouth, with no structured comparison tool.
- Landlords have no visibility into how their properties are perceived relative to competitors, and no channel to address tenant concerns proactively.
- Market scarcity pressures tenants to commit quickly to properties they are unsure of.

LivedIn addresses both sides:

- **Renters** get verified, experience-based insights to make informed decisions.
- **Landlords** get a reputation management tool to monitor, benchmark, and improve.

End Users

Primary Persona: Renter (Review Searcher)

Renters who browse the platform to screen properties based on verified reviews and trust scores before signing a lease. This includes:

- First-time renters without prior experience to rely on
- Renters relocating to a new city or neighbourhood
- Renters comparing multiple properties simultaneously

Secondary Persona: Renter (Review Leaver)

Renters who submit structured reviews about their living experience at a property, contributing to the platform's data layer.

Tertiary Persona: Landlord / Property Manager

(New in v2.0) Landlords and property managers who use the Business Portal to:

- Monitor portfolio trust scores and review volume across their properties
- View category-level performance analytics and trend data
- Benchmark their properties against city and neighbourhood averages
- Track renter sentiment signals (common themes, sentiment trends)
- Respond to reviews (subject to admin moderation)
- Identify review gaps and generate tenant invite links
- Manage team access with role-based permissions (viewer, editor, admin)
- Maintain company profile and notification preferences

Landlord Jobs-to-Be-Done

1. **Understand reputation:** “How do my properties score relative to the market?”
2. **Identify weaknesses:** “Which categories are dragging my trust score down?”
3. **Respond to feedback:** “A renter flagged maintenance delays—I want to acknowledge and address it.”
4. **Fill review gaps:** “My newest property has zero reviews—I need to encourage tenants to contribute.”
5. **Track trends:** “Is my portfolio improving or declining over time?”
6. **Delegate:** “My property manager needs access to review data but not team settings.”

Customer Discovery Highlights

1. **Renters want trust signals before committing:** responsiveness, professionalism, maintenance reliability, safety/security. They value predictability—clear rules, costs, fewer surprises.

2. **Living experience is unknown until after move-in:** decisions rely on subjective impressions during showings. Market scarcity leads tenants to commit faster to properties they are unsure of.
3. **Walk-throughs take significant time for landlords:** they want serious, informed interest from tenants, not tyre-kickers.
4. **Landlords want visibility into their reputation:** property managers expressed interest in understanding how their properties are perceived and how to improve.

Scope

This project delivers a rental trust platform that enables landlords and renters to exchange verified, non-financial trust signals alongside standard screening practices.

In Scope

- Verified review submission with structured five-metric scoring
- Public property browsing, search, and trust score display
- Property detail pages with category breakdowns and distilled insights
- **Neighbourhood browsing and detail pages** (new)
- **Property comparison tool** (new)
- **Renter dashboard with shortlist and review history** (new)
- **Business Portal for landlords/property managers** (new)
- Admin moderation, audit, and property management
- Authentication (email/password + Google OAuth)
- Anti-abuse controls (rate limits, one review per property per user, moderation)

Out of Scope

- Residency verification (identity documents, proof of address) — still out of scope
- Payment processing for landlord subscriptions (business model, not technical scope)
- Real-time notification delivery system (email/push infrastructure)
- Map-based property search with geolocation pins
- Implementing the New FE prototypes as standalone Vite SPAs
- Adopting the seven-category rating model from the prototype mock data

Constraints

- RentFaster is the established go-to platform for rental needs in the target market
- Building credibility from scratch remains a major constraint

- Focus on mitigation of abuse instead of inability

Assumptions

- Renters will engage with external platforms if it saves time and reduces risk
- Landlords will want to push the platform to their tenants for reputation visibility
- The market is difficult and current information asymmetry is sufficient motivation

Rating Model (Canonical)

The platform uses a **five-metric structured scoring model**. Each metric is rated on a 0–5 scale in half-star increments (0, 0.5, 1, 1.5, ..., 5). An overall **TrustScore** is computed as a weighted aggregate of the five metrics.

Metric	Prompt / Definition
Management Responsiveness	“After you reported an issue, how quickly did the landlord or property manager typically respond?”
Maintenance Timeliness	“If there were maintenance issues, were they resolved within a reasonable timeframe?”
Listing Accuracy	“When you moved in, did the property match what was advertised?”
Fee Transparency	“Were all fees, charges, and financial obligations communicated clearly and applied consistently?”
Lease Clarity	“Were expectations, rules, and processes for tenancy communicated clearly and followed reliably?”

Decision Record: Seven-Category Alternative Rejected

The New FE prototypes proposed a seven-category model (**maintenance, responsiveness, value, safety, noise, moveInOut, cleanliness**). This model is **rejected** because:

- It is incompatible with the existing database schema, validation logic, and aggregate pipeline
- It introduces subjective categories (“noise”, “cleanliness”) that overlap with existing metrics or fall outside the platform’s structured-trust focus
- Changing the metric model at this stage would require rewriting migrations, RLS policies, validation schemas, and all public aggregate display logic

The five-metric model remains canonical for all surfaces (public, portal, admin).

Features

Core Features (Existing)

Feature	Description	User	Key Benefit
Compiled Property Score (TrustScore)	Aggregated score based on structured renter inputs	Renter	Fast, comparable signal before signing a lease
Category Breakdown	Per-dimension performance display	Renter	Prevents “black box” score; helps match priorities
Structured Review Submission	Mandatory standardised categories, half-star precision	Renter	Consistent inputs for meaningful compiled scores
Account Verification	Email verification required; optional 2FA	Platform	Reduces spam and repeat submissions
Self-Reported Tenancy Period	Required tenancy time-frame (no proof required)	Renter	Adds temporal context to reviews
Private Context Field	Character-capped (500) private comments for moderation	Platform	Captures nuance without becoming a complaint forum
Anti-Abuse Controls	Rate limits, duplicate detection, admin moderation tools	Platform	Protects score integrity
Distilled Insights	AI-generated, admin-approved neutral summaries from approved review text	Renter	Accessible summary without exposing private text

Consumer UX Features (New)

Feature ID	Feature	User	Description
FR-CX-01	Neighbourhood Browsing	Renter	Browse and explore neighbourhood detail pages with property counts, average scores, and featured properties
FR-CX-02	Property Comparison	Renter	Side-by-side comparison of up to 3 properties across all five trust metrics
FR-CX-03	Multi-Step Review Wizard	Renter	Animated step progress with motion transitions; preserves existing validation and gating

Feature ID	Feature	User	Description
FR-CX-04	Renter Dashboard	Renter	Auth-gated dashboard showing submitted reviews, statuses, and shortlisted properties
FR-CX-05	Trust Score Badges	Renter	Visual trust score badges with category breakdowns and confidence indicators based on review count

Business Portal Features (New)

Feature ID	Feature	User	Description
FR-BP-01	Portfolio Dashboard	Landlord	Property cards with trust scores, funnel metrics, and trend indicators
FR-BP-02	Review Feed	Landlord	Filterable review feed with flagging and response actions
FR-BP-03	Moderation Queue	Landlord	Queue for flagged reviews within the landlord's portfolio
FR-BP-04	Category Performance	Landlord	Analytics charts showing per-category scores over time
FR-BP-05	Benchmark Comparison	Landlord	Side-by-side comparison against city/neighbourhood averages
FR-BP-06	Renter Signal Tracking	Landlord	Sentiment trends and common theme analysis
FR-BP-07	Review Gap Alerts	Landlord	Identifies properties with low review counts; generates tenant invite links

Feature ID	Feature	User	Description
FR-BP-08	Team Access Management	Landlord	Role-based access (viewer, editor, admin) for team members
FR-BP-09	Company Profile	Landlord	Editable public-facing company profile
FR-BP-10	Notification Preferences	Landlord	Per-user notification settings for review alerts, reports, and team activity

Technical Specifications

Stack

Layer	Technology
Framework	Next.js 16 (App Router) — single framework for all surfaces
Runtime	React 19, TypeScript 5
Styling	Tailwind CSS 4, semantic design tokens, shadcn/ui primitives
Database	Supabase Postgres with Row Level Security
Auth	Supabase Auth (email/password + Google OAuth)
Storage	Cloudflare R2 for property photos
Hosting	Vercel (continuous integration and deployment)
Charts	Recharts (Business Portal analytics)

Framework Decision Record

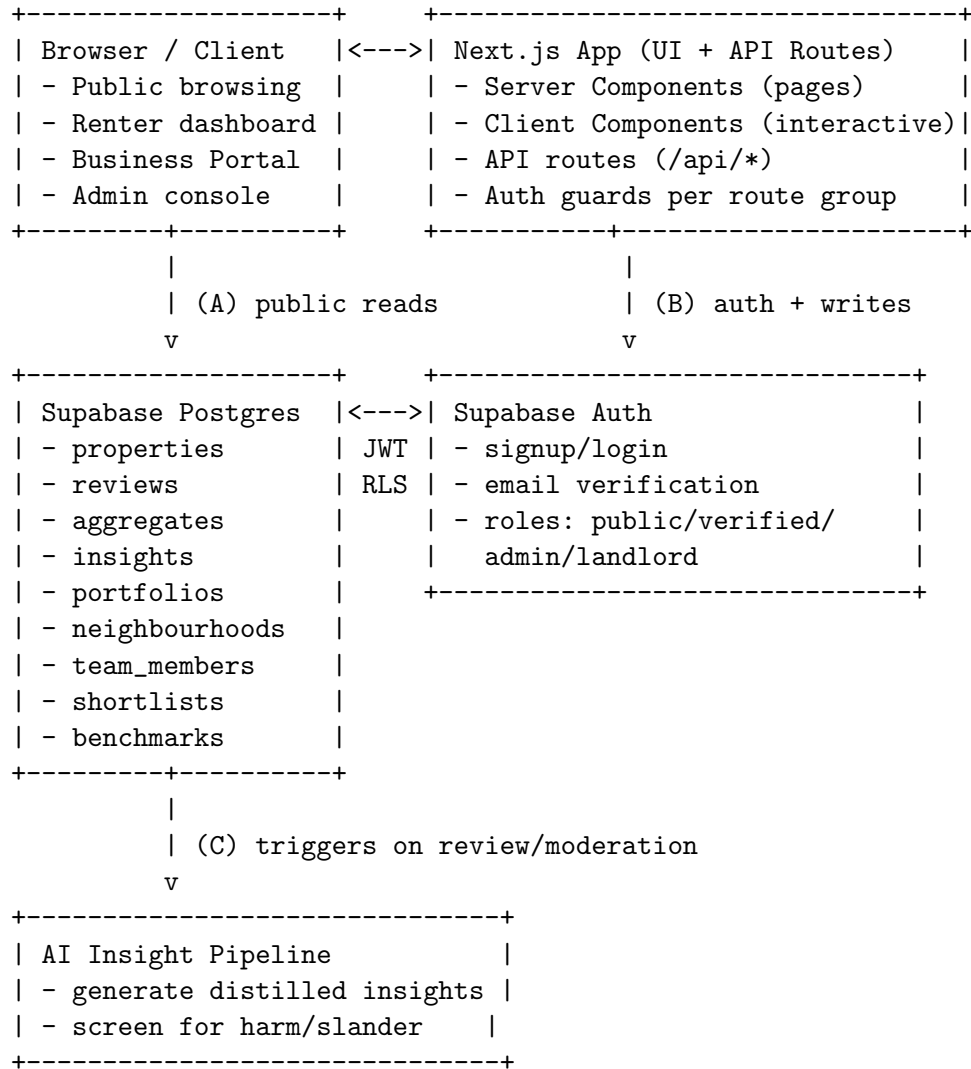
Decision: Next.js App Router is the single framework for all surfaces—public, Business Portal, and admin.

Rationale: The New FE prototypes (Facelift and Business Portal) were built as Vite + React Router SPAs with mock data. Adopting them as parallel stacks would create:

- Framework fragmentation (Next.js vs. Vite)
- Duplicated auth, data fetching, and type systems
- Two deployment pipelines
- Loss of SSR, ISR, and server components

Instead, the UX patterns and feature ideas from the prototypes are adopted into the existing Next.js architecture. The prototypes serve as design references, not production code.

Architecture



(D) photos (E) metadata
 Browser -----> Cloudflare R2 -----> Postgres

Route Groups

Group	Path Prefix	Auth Requirement
Public	/	None (browsing), verified (review submission)
Dashboard	/dashboard	Authenticated renter
Portal	/portal/*	landlord or admin role
Admin	/admin/*	admin role
Auth	/sign-in, /sign-up	None

Data Layer

- Supabase Postgres is the single source of truth for all data
- All tables have RLS enabled from creation
- No direct client-side Supabase access from the Business Portal—all data flows through Next.js API routes
- Server components fetch data server-side; client components use auth-aware fetch wrappers
- The `landlord` role is portfolio-scoped: landlords can only access properties linked to them via `portfolio_properties`

Database Evolution (New Tables)

The following tables extend the existing schema. All migrations are **additive only**—no destructive changes to existing tables, RLS policies, triggers, or aggregate pipelines.

Table / View	Purpose
<code>neighbourhoods</code>	Neighbourhood metadata for browsing (name, city, property count, avg trust score)
<code>user_shortlists</code>	Saved/shortlisted properties per user
<code>portfolio_properties</code>	Links landlord accounts to properties they manage
<code>team_members</code>	Business portal team members with role-based access (viewer, editor, admin)
<code>notification_preferences</code>	Per-user notification settings for the Business Portal
<code>review_response_drafts</code>	Landlord responses to reviews, subject to admin approval before publication
<code>benchmark_averages</code>	City/neighbourhood aggregate baselines for comparison

New Role: landlord

- Added to the `profiles.role` check constraint alongside existing roles (`public`, `verified`, `admin`)
- RLS policies enforce portfolio-scoped reads: landlords can read only their own portfolio properties and associated review/aggregate data
- Landlords **cannot** moderate reviews (admin-only)
- Landlords **can** create review response drafts (subject to admin approval)
- Team member access inherits the landlord's portfolio scope

API Contracts (New)

Business Portal APIs

Method	Endpoint	Description
GET	/api/portal/properties	Landlord's portfolio property list
GET	/api/portal/properties/[id]/analytics	Funnel metrics + category performance
GET	/api/portal/properties/[id]/reviews	Reviews for a specific property (landlord view)
GET	/api/portal/benchmarks	City/neighbourhood averages
GET	/api/portal/signals	Renter sentiment trends
POST	/api/portal/reviews/[id]/respond	Draft a response to a review

Consumer APIs

Method	Endpoint	Description
GET	/api/neighbourhoods	Public neighbourhood list
GET	/api/neighbourhoods/[id]	Neighbourhood detail with properties
POST	/api/user/shortlist	Add/remove shortlisted property
GET	/api/user/shortlist	Get user's shortlist

Competitive Positioning

Dimension	RentFaster	RateMyLandlord / Google Reviews	LivedIn
Focus	Listings and availability	Unstructured reviews	Structured trust scores
Review structure	N/A	Free-text, unstructured	Five mandatory metrics, half-star precision
Abuse mitigation	Minimal	Varies	Verified accounts, rate limits, admin moderation, no public free-text
Landlord tools	Listing management	None	Portfolio analytics, benchmarks, review responses, team management
Data quality	Listing data only	Low—fake/retaliatory risk	High—structured, moderated, aggregated

Risks and Mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
Privacy / access control errors	Strict RLS policies, role-based permissions, automated access tests
Review manipulation / gaming	Email-verified accounts, one review per property per account, rate limits, device/IP monitoring, admin moderation
Defamation risk	No public free-text reviews, structured scoring only, private context field for moderation, rapid flagged-content removal
Cold start / low review volume	Focus rollout on concentrated renter segments (students), allow browsing before signup, display review counts transparently, minimum thresholds before emphasising scores
Score misinterpretation	Category breakdowns, review volume indicators, clear explanations of score computation
Schema drift (New FE types vs. DB)	Five-metric model frozen in documentation before any code changes
Design system fragmentation	Palette/typography conflicts resolved in design-token unification phase before building screens
Framework divergence	Decision to stay on Next.js documented; no Vite/React Router code ported
Scope creep from porting prototypes	Features adopted by UX pattern, not by file copy; explicit acceptance criteria per phase
Breaking existing functionality	All new migrations are additive only; existing tables, RLS, and triggers untouched

User Interface Design

Public Screens

- **Landing / Home:** Hero content, search input, “Leave a review” CTA, featured neighbourhoods
- **Search Results:** Property cards with trust score badges, filter sidebar (neighbourhood, score range, property type), sort options (highest trust, most reviewed, recently added), URL-persisted state
- **Property Detail:** Trust score, category breakdown, confidence indicator, distilled insights, photos, review CTA
- **Neighbourhood List:** Grid of neighbourhood cards with property counts and average scores
- **Neighbourhood Detail:** Featured properties, area statistics, average category scores

- **Comparison:** Side-by-side view of up to 3 properties across all five metrics
- **Review Form:** Multi-step wizard with animated transitions, structured ratings, private context field
- **Renter Dashboard:** Submitted reviews with statuses, shortlisted properties, review history

Business Portal Screens

- **Portal Dashboard:** Portfolio overview with property cards, trust scores, trend indicators, funnel metrics
- **Review Feed:** Filterable by property, date range, rating; response drafting
- **Moderation Queue:** Flagged reviews within the landlord's portfolio
- **Category Performance:** Charts showing per-category score trends over time
- **Benchmark Comparison:** Portfolio properties vs. city/neighbourhood averages
- **Renter Signals:** Sentiment trends and common themes
- **Review Gap Alerts:** Properties with low coverage; tenant invite link generation
- **Team Management:** Invite, role assignment (viewer/editor/admin), removal
- **Company Profile:** Editable company information
- **Notification Settings:** Per-user alert preferences

User Flows

User A: Searching Reviews

1. Landing / Home page
2. Enter address, property name, or browse by neighbourhood
3. Filter and sort results
4. Select property to view detail
5. Review trust score, category breakdown, and distilled insights
6. Optionally compare with other properties
7. Optionally shortlist properties for later review
8. Decide whether to pursue the rental

User B: Leaving a Review

1. Landing / Home page → “Leave a Review” CTA
2. Search for and select the property
3. Complete structured rating form (five metrics, half-star precision)
4. Optionally add private context (500 character cap)

5. Provide tenancy period
6. Submit review (enters **pending** moderation queue)
7. Receive submission confirmation

User C: Landlord Managing Portfolio (New)

1. Sign in with landlord account
2. Access Business Portal from header navigation
3. View portfolio dashboard with property cards and trust scores
4. Drill into a specific property for category performance analytics
5. View benchmark comparison against city/neighbourhood averages
6. Review and respond to tenant reviews (draft enters admin approval queue)
7. Check review gap alerts; generate invite links for under-reviewed properties
8. Manage team members and notification preferences

Project Timeline and Roadmap

Phase 1 (Jan–Feb): Discovery + Prototype

- Finalise MVP scope and flows
- Build wireframes and high-fidelity prototype in Figma
- Run usability tests and iterate
- **Deliverable:** Polished clickable prototype (Demo Day 1, Feb 26)

Phase 2 (March–April): MVP Build

- Set up authentication, database, and core schema
- Build public browsing, property detail, review submission
- Build admin console (properties CRUD, moderation, audit)
- Implement distilled insights pipeline
- **Deliverable:** Functional core product

Phase 3 (April–May): Expansion + Business Portal

- Documentation reconciliation and design-system unification
- Schema evolution (new tables, landlord role, RLS policies)
- Consumer UX adoption (neighbourhoods, comparison, dashboard, shortlist)
- Business Portal implementation (all 10 portal screens)
- Shared infrastructure (API client, a11y, mobile responsiveness)

- Cleanup and deprecation of prototype code
- **Deliverable:** Functional MVP with two-sided marketplace (Demo Day 2, May 27)

Validation Plan

- Conduct 10–15 follow-up usability tests on the clickable prototype with renters
- Validate: onboarding clarity, trust signal comprehension, category coverage adequacy
- Measure engagement with new features: neighbourhood browsing, comparison tool, shortlist usage
- Gather landlord feedback on Business Portal usability and value proposition
- Track: “How much additional engagement do landlord tools create?”

Dependencies

- **User adoption:** Initial data collection depends on ability to pitch to building companies. Renter participation depends on emphasising value.
- **Data quality:** Honest, consistent structured inputs to ensure scoring integrity.
- **Legal and policy:** Compliance with Canadian and provincial housing, privacy, and anti-discrimination laws. Building-focused, not individual-focused.
- **Trust and safety:** Email verification, abuse mitigation, and moderation to prevent misuse.
- **Clear value proposition:** Renters need enough data to keep using the platform. Landlords must receive measurable benefits to remain engaged.
- **Slices 01–17:** Core product must be complete before Business Portal and consumer UX expansion (Slice 50).